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5 June 2026
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Dear Dr. Guillermo Orti and Editors of Molecular Phylogenetics and Evolution,

We would like to begin by thanking you, Dr. Eli Greenbaum, and an anonymous reviewer for your creative and valuable thoughts. On behalf of myself and my coauthors, we appreciate your time and contributions.

All reviewers provided carefully considered comments and we have done our best to accommodate those suggestions here. The most significant changes include incorporating a number of important microhylid studies that we missed in our previous version and expanding our discussion to provide more context for the diversification of microhylid frogs. We believe these additions substantially improve our argument and the quality of the manuscript.

In our submission you will find two versions of our manuscript, one with all changes highlighted in **red text** ("Markup") and a second without these changes highlighted ("Clean"). In our response to reviewers we highlight reviewer comments in **green**, and our responses in black. New text added to the manuscript is **highlighted**. We have formatted a page break between each reviewer. Where necessary, we have interjected our responses among reviewer comments.

Thank you for your time and consideration,

Ian Brennan (on behalf of all coauthors)

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